Even before the crisis, neither Nehru nor Dutt had believed Chinese accusations that the US would switch to a “two Chinas” policy or use Taiwan to attack the mainland.[210] The crisis, however, caused “grave concern” in India because of the potential for escalation. Internally, officials believed that the root cause was the lack of American recognition of China. The government did not, however, agree with the Chinese use of force.[211]

Publicly, during the crisis, Nehru reiterated India’s position that Taiwan belonged to China, but emphasized that Beijing did not have the right to use force to take over Taiwan or the offshore islands. Krishna Menon, however, took a more activist stance at the UN, pushing for a vote on Chinese representation and assigning blame to Taipei. This created consternation in Washington.[212] When the crisis had broken out, Dulles had favored the idea of using Delhi to convey messages to Beijing. After Krishna Menon’s statements, however, he agreed with the UN secretary-general that India was too partial to be acceptable as mediator. Subsequently, rather than railing against the Indian role publicly as they had in the past, American officials quietly worked to exclude Krishna Menon. Senior State Department officials gave Nehru at least the benefit of the doubt, noting that he was probably getting erroneous reports.[213] Indian embassy officials in Washington, on their part, subsequently gave Dulles “credit” for restraining Jiang.[214]

Another subject of difference between Delhi and Washington continued to be the US relationship with Pakistan. After 1956, however, Nehru’s public criticism of the US-Pakistan military supply relationship seemed more measured than in the past. Furthermore, he acknowledged—including privately to Soviet deputy premier Anastas Ivanovich Mikoyan—that the US did not want these weapons used against India and that he did not mistrust American motives.[215] Publicly, while highlighting India’s concern about the implementation of US assurances regarding Pakistani use of US-supplied weapons, he also noted that he did not doubt the “genuineness” of the assurances.”[216]

When news reports emerged of US military activity in Pakistan-held Kashmir, instead of reacting publicly, Nehru asked his officials to seek clarification from the US privately. The US ambassador, in turn, denied the presence of US “installations” there. American policymakers also repeatedly reassured India about the guarantees they had elicited from